

RAJ THAKKAR

Cybersecurity Governance, Risk & Compliance Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with over a decade of experience securing regulated financial services environments through technical control implementation, security assessment, and risk-driven engineering. Hands-on across NIST CSF and 800-53, ISO 27001, cloud security governance, threat and vulnerability management, and security architecture, with deep command of regulatory frameworks (FFIEC, GLBA, GDPR, PCI DSS). Embeds security controls into system design, automates GRC operations with Power Platform, and is actively extending the practice into AI governance, generative AI, and enterprise Microsoft 365 Copilot adoption.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Information Systems Auditor (CISA) • CompTIA Security+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Vice President, Cybersecurity Compliance Senior Consultant **2022 – Present**
Truist Financial Corporation • Atlanta, GA

- Embed security controls into system design, operations, and change-management workflows by partnering with platform, infrastructure, cloud, and engineering teams.
- Identify security and operational risk gaps across complex technology environments and drive pragmatic, technically grounded remediation plans with engineering and cyber teams.
- Lead enterprise wires and funds-movement risk assessments covering high-impact, time-critical transaction flows and their supporting technology and security controls.
- Own the enterprise Cyber Maturity Assessment (CMA), including methodology design, regulatory mapping, SME coordination, vendor management, and execution.
- Manage control evidence and narratives across 277+ diagnostic statements aligned to NIST CSF, ISO 27001, FFIEC, GLBA, and internal standards.
- Develop Power Platform (Power Apps, Power Automate) solutions and automated workflows that streamline control evidence collection, assessment processes, and security reporting across the enterprise.
- Support enterprise adoption of Microsoft 365 Copilot and AI tooling, evaluating use cases for security, data-protection, and governance risk and helping shape responsible-use controls.
- Produce executive- and regulator-facing reporting explaining risk posture, control maturity, and remediation priorities.

Senior Information Security Program Strategist **2020 – 2022**
Truist Financial Corporation • Atlanta, GA

- Built cyber risk and compliance metrics providing leadership visibility into control effectiveness, risk posture, and program maturity.
- Drove security-by-design practices across technology initiatives to align engineering delivery with risk and compliance requirements.
- Produced executive-level risk, audit, and compliance reporting for First and Second Lines of Defense to support regulatory and audit engagements.
- Strengthened governance and control oversight processes to improve audit readiness across large, cross-functional security programs.

Cybersecurity & Privacy Consultant **2018 – 2020**
PwC • Atlanta, GA

- Led cybersecurity and compliance assessments for Fortune 500 financial services clients, delivering gap analyses, remediation roadmaps, and audit-ready documentation.
- Implemented and assessed controls aligned to NIST, ISO 27001, GDPR, CCPA, GLBA, HIPAA, and other industry frameworks.
- Coordinated third-party testing, including vulnerability assessments and penetration tests, in complex, high-risk environments.
- Developed client-facing governance documentation supporting regulatory exams, certifications, and large transformation programs.
- Advised clients on privacy and regulatory requirements for compliant adoption of new platforms and technologies.

Information Security Analyst

2016 – 2018

Aprio • Atlanta, GA

- Led PCI DSS assessments end to end, including planning, testing, and development of ROC and AOC reports.
- Assessed access controls, incident response, SDLC, and change management practices in regulated environments.
- Delivered recurring risk and control reporting to leadership highlighting gaps and remediation priorities.

Internal Auditor

2014 – 2015

Sherwin-Williams • Cleveland, OH

- Conducted financial and operational audits across 60+ retail and distribution locations.
- Evaluated controls over financial processes, inventory, cash handling, and operations; identified gaps and remediation actions.
- Prepared audit reports and risk summaries for senior management and tracked remediation efforts.
- Partnered with Loss Prevention, Sales, and Finance teams to improve control effectiveness across distributed operations.

Finance Intern

2014

Sherwin-Williams • Cleveland, OH

- Supported budgeting, forecasting, and variance analysis for regional operations, and improved financial reporting efficiency by 15% by streamlining reporting processes.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Information Systems Audit & Control — Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA

Bachelor of Business Administration, Accounting — Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA

SKILLS

Security & Technical: Security Architecture & Control Implementation, Cloud & Infrastructure Security Governance, Threat & Vulnerability Management, Operational Resilience, Change & Configuration Security, GRC Workflow Automation

AI & Automation: AI Governance & Responsible-Use Controls, Microsoft 365 Copilot Security & Adoption, Generative AI & AI Agent Development, Copilot Prompting & Prompt Engineering, Microsoft Power Platform (Power Apps, Power Automate), Workflow Automation

GRC & Security Platforms: ServiceNow GRC, Archer, Microsoft 365 Security & Compliance

Frameworks: NIST CSF, NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, SOC 2, FFIEC, GLBA, GDPR, CCPA, HIPAA, PCI DSS

Risk & Assurance: Cyber Maturity Assessments, Control Evidence & Assurance, Third-Party Risk, Regulatory Exam Readiness, Policy & Standards Development